



4.02 Working Alone

1. Purpose

The purpose of this Standard Operating Procedure is to identify the hazards and define the steps in “Working Alone”. During travel or working on a customer’s site.

2. Scope

This procedure is intended for use by all Silverpoint employees .

3. Hazard Assessment & Identification

- Physical Stress
- Mental Stress
- Slips, Trips, Falls
- Bending , Lifting , Twisting
- Pushing , Pulling
- Pinch Points
- Weather
- Limited Visibility
- Driving
- Personal Injury
- Ergonomics
- Complacency
- Fatigue
- Excessive Noise
- Equipment Failure
- Potential Energy
- Pressurized Liquids
- Release to The Environment
- Exposure to Flammable Substance



4. EHS Requirements

- Fire Retardant Coveralls .
- Steel Toed Boots .
- Safety Glasses .
- Rubber Gloves .
- Hardhat .
- Hearing Protection .
- Seat Belts .
- Obey Speed Limits .
- Drive According to Road Conditions .
- Keep Eyes on the Task and Pay Attention
- Stay With Vehicle .
- Survival Kit
- First Aid Kit
- Electronic Communication

5. References

- Silverpoint Corporate Codes of Practice
- Alberta OH&S
- Silverpoint Task List
- Silverpoint THA 4.02

6. Procedure

- 6.1. The first step you must take when you are working alone is to minimize or eliminate exposure . How we accomplish this is to first understand that you are about to work alone , and the risk involved . We can then begin to recognize the hazards and put controls in place to minimize exposure and provide a safe environment to work alone in.
- 6.2. When you are dispatched to a project , most of the time you will be traveling alone . You must first assess the situation , what is the weather like , what are the road conditions ; do you have everything you need to make the trip ? Map , Land description , detailed directions , which route you will be taking . Do you have an Emergency Response Plan (ERP) in place ?



6.3. Do you have a contact who you can keep in touch with during your trip?

6.3.1. Does your contact have all the pertinent information, e.g. Your ETA, your destination, phone numbers, radio frequency, spread field, remote sump and cement pit locations, your route, fuel location and Emergency Notification List?

6.4. Do you have all the necessary information you need to make the trip, e.g., your destination, phone numbers (tech, consultant, message center, contact, after hours number) which is **1-888-977-2327**

6.5. Have you ensured that your electronic communication equipment is charged and operational? E.g., 2-way radio, cell phone, GPS.

7. Call-in

7.1. Should you encounter a problem while you are working or traveling alone, e.g., vehicle break-down, stuck, lost, unsafe to proceed, accident, bad weather, road closure, personal injury, poor visibility or fatigue, **"STOP"**, remain calm and stay with the vehicle. Call your pre-arranged contact and inform them of your situation.

7.2. Make yourself as visible as possible. Turn on your work lights, your beacons, your hazard lights, flash your headlights, set out road flares so when your contact comes looking for you, they will be able to see you.

7.3. The cab of the vehicle is the safest place to be. It will protect you against the weather and may be equipped with a Global Tracking System. So as long as you stay with the vehicle someone will know where you are. There is also a first aid kit, a survival kit, and an eyewash station should you require them.

7.4. If you cannot call in and everything is in place, The ERP will take effect and you will be located.

7.5. If you are unable to check in with your contact but everything is fine, call in as soon as possible before ERP takes effect.

7.6. If you know that you will be working or traveling alone in a no service area, let your contact know. You may have to use other means of communication e.g. 2-way radio.

8. Stages of Risk

There are various stages of risk when working alone. Each situation will present different hazards which may increase the level of risk involved in working alone. At each stage, depending on what the hazards are, controls will be necessary to minimize the risk of exposure to working alone.

You must take the time to recognize when you will be in a high risk working alone situation and implement the proper controls to protect yourself.

8.1. **Level one:** At this stage of risk, minimal hazards are present and the controls to be put in place should reflect the level of risk. E.g., you are working on the rig, and you are about to take a load to the spread field which is just off lease. It is a sunny day with no wind, and you have a long flat spread field. At this point you are in view of the rig and in a safe walking distance. The hazards of working alone are very minimal or nonexistent. The controls that can be put into place at this level could be: Post your phone number and or radio frequency in the doghouse and let the derrick hand



know that if there is a problem , you will turn on your beacons .

- 8.2. **Level two:** At this stage of risk, moderate hazards are present . E.g., you are taking a load to the spread field which is a mile or two away and you can just barely see the rig in the distance . It is -10 degrees outside , and you are too far to walk to the rig safely . The controls that could be put into place at this time may be, let the derrick hand know your ETA, your phone number and or radio frequency and if a problem occurs you will turn on your beacons . Also let him know that if you are not back at the designated time, he should try to get a hold of you. At this point the hazards present dictate that you should stay with the vehicle to avoid any injury . You should also try to contact the rig via 2-way or phone . If you cannot reach the rig, call your environmental tech, rig manager or if available , your shift supervisor and inform them of your situation .
- 8.3. **Level three:** At this stage of risk, the hazards present are high . E.g., you are taking a load to a remote sump . It is 30 kms away down a one lane ice road at night in the bush . Visibility is low because of blowing snow and darkness . The temperature outside is -40 with wind chill . Skin will freeze within a minute of exposure . At this point the controls to be put in place to minimize risk could be, ensure you are chained up, electronic communication devices are charged and operational , perform a radio check, ensure you have full winter PPE, you have a fully stocked survival kit with you, beacons and work lights are operational , drive as road conditions dictate , rig manager has all the information required e.g. pre-spray map, phone numbers and radio frequency and that he is aware of the hazards present . Also ensure that the derrick hand knows that you are about to take a load and has access to all the information including your ETA . In addition , you may want to start a check in via 2-way radio or cell phone depending on coverage every few kilometers with a pre-arranged contact that can monitor radio communication to ensure that everything is going safely .
- 8.4. **Level four:** At this stage of risk, the hazards present are extreme ; serious injury may result if you continue . E.g., you are taking a load to the spread field which is 13 kms away down a goat trail in thick heavy fog, zero visibility . You cannot see the rig or the hood of the truck . You cannot see anything . At this point you may want to consider not leaving the lease until it is safe to do so . Inform the rig manager of the hazard that is present and fill out a hazard I.D. The control to be put into place here would be not to continue . This is an action , but in this particular situation it is a control . Remember , "Controls are put into place to minimize hazards and limit the risk of exposure " . Therefore , in this situation you are effectively eliminating the risk of exposure by not continuing .
- 8.5. These are examples of what can occur and controls that can be put in place to minimize the risk of working alone . There are many different scenarios for each level of risk and hazards that accompany those risks . It is up to **you** to ensure that the proper controls are utilized to minimize hazards and limit the risk of exposure to working alone . Good advice to follow is, if there are no controls that can be put in place to minimize the risk of working alone you should **"STOP"** and continue only when it is safe to do so .

Remember : if you are in doubt about what to do, call your Supervisor